



MONTHLY UPDATE

Tunisia: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-06 • 37 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • DATA

Summary of the month

Digitalisation was declared a necessity and the state's own platforms were tested by their users. The head of government [chaired a ministerial council on digitalisation, stating that it is a necessity rather than a choice](#), with [114 projects in execution](#) and [192 under national tracking](#). The tax directorate [opened online business tax registration](#), the industry ministry [put its unified services platform into use on 28 August](#), and [34 digital service houses were completed across 21 governorates](#).

Then the education platform showed what happens when a channel becomes the only channel: [online school enrolment was reported failing during the enrolment period](#). On artificial intelligence the [outlines of a national strategy went to a restricted ministerial council and were immediately criticised as vague](#), while a diaspora association [published its own open-source white paper](#). A published legal analysis separately [found no rule allocating the loss when an electronic payment is compromised](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Policy movement in the window was a meeting rather than an instrument. The head of government [chaired a ministerial council devoted to digitalisation, stating that it is a necessity rather than a choice](#). The council's decisions are not itemised in the record held, so what the base can carry is the fact that it met and the framing it used.

The customs administration [settled a 2026-2030 strategic plan built around digitisation, presented with a governance charter, its axes covering border protection, an environment for attracting foreign investment, revenue collection, working methods and social responsibility](#); the plan document itself is not published.

Regional collaboration

Tunisia chairs and convenes rather than signs. It [was elected chair of the Arab League's working group on artificial-intelligence innovation and technological solutions at the permanent committee's inaugural meeting in Tunis](#), and [hosted the ninth Arab conference of directors of nationality and civil-status departments, which closed in Tunis on 19 August](#). Neither carries a work programme, a decision or a text on the record.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

A restricted ministerial council on [4 August 2026](#) set the orientations of the 2027 draft budget and named accelerating the digital transition as a structuring axis, alongside investment, formalisation of the informal sector, tax equity and renewable energy. No allocation, target or named programme is attached to the digital line, so nothing here establishes what the state intends to spend on it.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

A measurement study of North African 5G published on [3 August 2026](#), cited rather than absorbed, reports the Tunisian 5G median down 30% from launch by month six and the combined 4G and 5G median below the pre-launch baseline, while fixed-wireless lines rose to 319,554 by May 2026 under the regulator's 30 Mbps obligation. Nothing published bears on the submarine cables, data centres or satellite licensing.

The one physical build to move was a stalled one. The grands projets commission [ordered immediate procurement to complete the Cite Numerique d'Ennahli technology park](#) at a review session chaired by the Prime Minister on 10 August, alongside unrelated power-station and hospital projects. No cost, completion date, occupancy plan or account of why the park was incomplete is stated.

Cybersecurity

The national cybersecurity agency [warned on 30 July 2026 of an SMS phishing campaign](#) built on fake unpaid-traffic-fine notices sent from foreign numbers, carrying links to counterfeit platforms that harvest banking and personal data. Its advice was to distrust unsolicited messages, and its offered test was that Tunisian government sites use only the national domain. The lure borrows the credibility of the state's own digitised payment channels; the response on record carries no takedown power and names no data-protection authority. A [second alert on 14 August](#) warned of a surge in social-media account takeovers worked through SMS and email verification-code social engineering.

The scale behind the alerts was published on 7 August: [57,430 cyberattacks recorded in the first half of 2025, and ransomware cases up 140% to 37,076 in 2024](#), on interior ministry and agency figures, as the government finalised a National Cybersecurity Strategy 2026-2030 aimed at critical-infrastructure resilience and skills. The two figures cover different periods and are not a series; no definition of a recorded attack and no incident-reporting obligation behind the count is stated.

The administration was then given a baseline to meet. Circular n. 5 of 2 September requires [encrypted connections across official sites and platforms, mandatory renewal of security certificates, two-factor verification for administrator access, protection against traffic-saturation attacks and hosting on servers approved by the state](#); it [bans the use of messaging apps and social media for exchanging official documents and requires regular audits, immediate reporting of incidents to the national cybersecurity agency and an end to the sharing of credentials between colleagues](#). It binds the administration rather than the wider economy, and no compliance deadline, audit schedule, budget or list of approved hosting providers accompanies it.

DPI

Data Exchange

The customs estate opened a build rather than a service. The customs administration [began the execution phase of an integrated electronic rules-of-origin system financed by a bilateral partner, with technical preparation running to 18 September 2026](#). The dated stage is the preparation, not the go-live: no operating date, trader-facing interface or cost is published.

Digital Identity and CRVS

From 1 July 2026 the mobile identity became a condition of transacting with the state: the [investment authority made it mandatory for all investment-project declarations](#).

The health identifier's provenance became public on [27 July 2026](#). A ministry adviser confirmed that the identifier built for Covid-19 vaccination, holding records of over 3 million childhood immunisations, was adopted as the national health identifier and bound to the national identity card, the social security number and school and university identifiers. [Roughly 100,000 medical files had been linked](#). On protection of that linked dataset the ministry asserts only that data is stored confidentially and securely.

A second identifier moved a step behind it. At a ministerial session at La Kasbah on 18 August the government decided to [upgrade the social identifier system, digitise social-security cards and services and put interconnected systems in place for real-time data exchange between the social funds, health structures and insured persons](#), with drafting of the reform texts to begin immediately. The communique states no timetable, no legal basis for the identifier and no scope.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Tunisia's payments market is large enough for the question of who bears a loss to matter, and the law does not answer it. A published legal analysis finds [no Tunisian text — not the 2000 electronic commerce law, the 2023 cybersecurity decree-law, nor the central bank's 2024 circular — allocating the loss between bank, merchant and cardholder when an electronic payment is hijacked, altered or blocked by a cyber incident](#), against 164.8 million transactions worth 29.5bn dinars in 2025, up 12.3%, and reported cyber incidents rising from 63,000 in 2021 to more than 155,000 in 2022. The absence is now recorded as a gap.

The month's other payments item was an outage notice rather than a policy: the interbank switch [announced a planned technical intervention overnight on 11 August](#), which is the only public statement the base holds about the availability of the rail those 164.8 million transactions run on.

The founding instrument behind the online honour loans is now held: [Decree 2026-148 of 23 July 2026, published in the official journal, fixes the conditions and criteria on which the micro-financings are granted](#) - the text the base had been carrying only through a secondary account of its ceilings and grace period.

Registries

The social-housing application platform [has a completion timetable, set at a follow-up meeting on 3 August, with interconnection to the beneficiary database still under way](#). The interconnection is the part that decides what the platform is: an application front end that cannot read the beneficiary register is a form, and no date for that link is published.

Sectoral management information systems

The health estate reported volume and the education estate reported failure. [120,000 remote examinations were carried out across 26 hospitals](#), with no period, denominator or specialty breakdown stated. The education ministry's school-life platform, launched at the start of the month, was within three weeks [reported failing during the enrolment period](#), with no service-availability figure, incident account or fallback route published.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Two more registers moved. The employment ministry [launched the national register of community companies on 20 July 2026](#), and the launch figures were the disclosure: 230 companies created, 15,000 participants, but only 60 operational and 380 jobs. On [4 August the tax directorate put business tax registration online](#), ending the required visit to a tax office; it was announced by video capsule rather than by gazette, and its confidentiality assurance names no instrument and no supervisory authority.

A restricted ministerial council of 16 August put a count on the rest: [114 projects in execution, some reported above 90% complete](#), covering remote residence certificates, driving-licence renewal, remote passport and identity-card applications, the national health identifier and the customs and health-insurance systems. It is not the same measure as the 192 projects the February council tracked, and the two should not be read as a fall. The council also announced [the imminent launch of a Khadamet mobile application offering more than 40 administrative services, reached through the national digital identity and paid by card or virtual wallet](#). No launch date was given, and the application sits on top of the existing administrative portal of the same name rather than replacing it.

The industry ministry [opened a unified digital services platform on 28 August, its first online service the technical cards governing effective transfer operations - more than 4,000 a year - filed and processed entirely online and interconnected with customs so data is exchanged and decisions notified in real time](#), running on the national digital identity mechanisms and linked to the enterprise register, with import authorisations, an olive oil promotion fund and establishment licences to follow.

Technology

AI

The period's artificial-intelligence document came from outside the state. A diaspora alumni association [presented a Livre Blanc at the Tunisia Global Forum on 21-22 July](#) and its contents were [reported on 5 August 2026](#): a 2030 vision of a country able to create, adopt and deploy trustworthy artificial intelligence, against a stated baseline of 12.7% adoption at end-2025 and 4,120 developers per million inhabitants. It [names the constraints as the absence of large-scale data centres and sovereign compute, brain drain, and small firms that are 90% of the economic fabric](#), and prescribes frugal compute investment sized by measured demand. The document is declared open source and is not posted anywhere reachable, so all of that is held at press-summary precision.

The state's own document surfaced at the end of the window and settles a gap this ledger has carried. At a restricted ministerial council on 16 August the communication technologies minister [set out the main lines of a National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2026-2030](#). That establishes the instrument exists and is dated; it does not publish it. No adopted text, cabinet decision, budget or roadmap accompanies the presentation, so the strategy moves from *not held* to in development and no further.

Innovation ecosystem

The startup framework reached for the diaspora. The Dot [opened applications for Dot Landing, a diaspora-entrepreneur programme targeting 30 to 45 founders across three cohorts by 2028](#). It is a pipeline programme with a target and no results yet; the record held carries no count of founders returned, companies incorporated or capital placed under it.

Capacity

Training and skills

The family and women's ministry, a national entrepreneurs' organisation and a UN regional commission [opened a training programme for 100 women entrepreneurs in e-commerce and artificial-intelligence applications, alongside a national platform for marketing women's products](#). Both sit under a declaration on women, youth, digitalisation and African economic integration whose action plan targets training 100,000 women and young people in e-commerce, AI and cross-border digital payments by 2028, and a US\$50m fund for inclusive markets by the same date. The training launch's own date is not established in the source.

Data

Open data

The national public data registry [is confirmed live and enabling citizen data requests, in an independent reporting-mechanism report on the country's open-government commitments](#). Confirmation by an external reviewer is a stronger record than a launch announcement, and no dataset count, request volume or response-time figure accompanies it.

Where the state does not count, others do: a civil-society organisation [announced a femicide data platform for launch on 12 August](#). No official series on the same subject is held.

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